

Elena Giuliano

Curriculum vitae



Date of birth: 26 September 1995

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Professional profile

PhD-trained scientist with experience and passion for communicating science through multiple formats. Outreach contributions include writing of peer-reviewed scientific articles and blog posts, presentations at conferences, support to social media communication and to science outreach events. I have strong interest in teaching science and contributing to interdisciplinary communication projects positioned at the interface between general knowledge, science and art.

Communication and Outreach experience

Science writing:

- *Digging for meaningful connections: associations between root phenotypes and rhizosphere microbial diversity in maize.* Giuliano E. et al. (2026). In bioRxiv ([link to the article](#)) and accepted by Plant and Soil.
- *Shovelomics meets microbiomics: root phenotype-microbiome associations and links with maize yield under nitrogen limitation.* In Rhizosphere 37, 101241. Giuliano E. et al. (2026). [Link to the article](#)
- *Meet the SAE team section.* Series of interviews of the members of the Sustainable Agroecosystems group at ETH Zurich (2025). [Link to the section](#)
- *Thirsty plants? Soil microbes to the rescue!* In Facts&Reasons. Giuliano E. (2024). [Link to the article](#)
- *How meditation changes your brain.* In Facts&Reasons. Giuliano E. & Tichy N. (2024). [Link to the article](#)
- *The Fascinating World of Belowground Communication.* In Frontiers for Young Minds 8:547590. Ariotti C., Giuliano E., Garbeva P., Vigani G. (2020). [Link to the article](#)

Outreach projects and events:

- **Facts&Reasons online blog** ([link](#)): I supported social media management and content creation, and proof- and content-reading of blog articles (Zurich, Switzerland, Mar-Dec 2024).
- **Science communication workshop** and **Creative science communication course** (Life Science Zurich and Zurich-Basel Plant Science Center): I learned how to develop a small science communication project combining writing, visual art and social media and to create a prototype for a science communication activity (Zurich, Switzerland, Feb 2024, Feb 2023).
- **6th Global Science Film Festival**: I supported event operations by helping coordinating volunteer task assignments, managing ticketing, guest reception, and aperitifs, and introducing filmmakers on stage. I served as the main event's photographer, with pictures available on the [website](#) (Zurich, Switzerland, Nov 2024).
- **Pint of Science Festival**: I supported the preparation of the venues and the welcoming of speakers and guests over three days (Zurich, Switzerland, May 2024).
- **Galileo Science and Innovation Festival**: I was member of the student jury for the annual award to the best science communication book (Padova, Italy, May 2018).

Scientific oral communication:

- **Poster pitch and presentation:**
 - Swiss Mycology Symposium (Zurich, Switzerland, Jun 2023)
 - 3rd Global Soil Biodiversity (GSB) scientific conference (Dublin, Ireland, Mar 2023)

- International Society for Microbial Ecology (ISME) scientific conference (Lausanne, Switzerland, Aug 2022)
- Agricultural Chemistry Winter School (Torino, Italy, Feb 2020)
- **Conference talk:**
 - miCROPe scientific conference (Vienna, Austria, Jul 2024)

Front-of-house experience

- **Receptionist at the Collegio R. Einaudi University residence:** guest and mail reception, problem solving, answering and routing calls. Activity lasting three months per year determined through a university merit-based annual selection (Torino, Italy, 2016-2019).
- **Volunteer at the Collegio R. Einaudi University residence:** representation of the residence during the *Just the Women I am* fundraising city run by overseeing the outreach booth and interacting with the public (Torino, Italy, Mar 2018).

Teaching experience

- **Teaching assistant** to the following University courses: *Comparative Anatomy* (40 hours, Mar-May 2018) and *Plant Ecophysiology* (40 hours, Apr-Jun 2019) laboratory classes at the University of Torino (Italy); *Applied Laboratory Techniques in Agricultural Science* (one day per year, 2021-2024) and *Scientific Visualizations using R* (one class, 2022) at ETH Zurich (Switzerland).

Relevant academic experience

- **Doctorate in Agricultural Sciences at ETH Zurich** (Sustainable Agroecosystems group): focus on root-microbe interactions in maize under abiotic stress (Zurich, Switzerland, May 2021-Feb 2026). Title of Dr. sc. obtained on the 20th of May 2026.
- **Intern and scientific assistant at ETH Zurich** (Sustainable Agroecosystems group): support to research activities in the greenhouse and in the molecular laboratory (Zurich, Switzerland, Aug 2020-Apr 2021).
- **Intern at NIOO-KNAW** (Department of Microbial Ecology): support to research activities and master's thesis development (Erasmus Traineeship Program; Wageningen, The Netherlands, Sep-Dec 2019).
- **Intern in Plant Physiology at the University of Oviedo:** support to experimental activities in the greenhouse and in the lab (Erasmus+ Exchange program; Oviedo, Spain, Oct-Dec 2018).

Education

- **M.Sc. in Environmental Biology, University of Torino.** Grade: 110/110 *cum Laude* with Honors (Torino, Italy, Sep 2017-Apr 2020).
- **M.Sc. in Biotechnology Applied to Conservation and Sustainable Management of Plant Resources, University of Oviedo.** Erasmus+ Exchange program (Oviedo, Spain, Sep 2018-Jan 2019).
- **B.Sc. in Biology, University of Torino.** Grade: 110/110 *cum Laude* (Torino, Italy, Sep 2014-Jul 2017).

Awards and scholarships

- **Exchange Program Scholarship** and **Academic Merit Awards**, awarded by the Collegio Einaudi (2017-2019).
- **Student Academy Scholarship**, Galileo Science and Innovation Festival (2018).
- **First and Second prizes** at “IV Dante’s Certamen” and “Your invisible city” literary contests (2012, 2013).

Communication and IT skills

- **Languages:** Italian (native), English (professional working proficiency, C1; IELTS 6.5, 2019; Cambridge FCE B2, 2016), Spanish (B2 level certificate, University of Oviedo, 2018; B2 level course, Language Center UZH-ETH Zurich, 2022), French (beginner), German (beginner).
- **IT:** R/R studio (working proficiency), RootScan, ImageJ, Microsoft Office tools, ArcGIS/QGIS, Inkscape, WordPress, social media (Instagram, Facebook, X, LinkedIn), AI tools (ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot).

Hobbies

Drawing, Painting, Photography, Reading, Writing, Crocheting, Sport (e.g., pilates, jogging, dancing).